Human development as recursive belief updating

Each consequence becomes the next activating event. Examining a belief produces a revised outlook that later beliefs keep building on.

1

2

3

4

$A_1 \rightarrow B_1 \rightarrow C_1$

$A_2 \rightarrow B_2 \rightarrow C_2$

D

E





Activating event

Something happens, such as a tense conversation.

Belief

How the event is interpreted in the moment.

Updated belief

Shaped by what the first consequence taught.

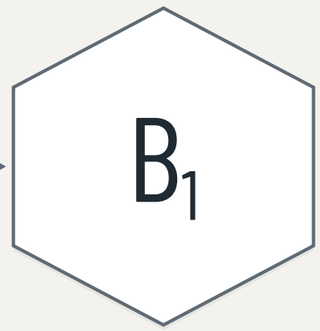
Examination

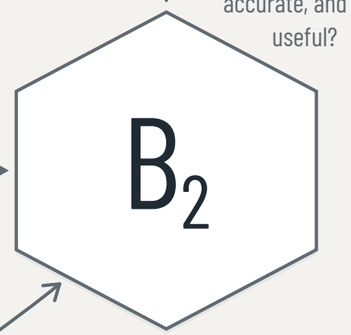
Question the belief: is it accurate, and is it useful?

Revised outlook

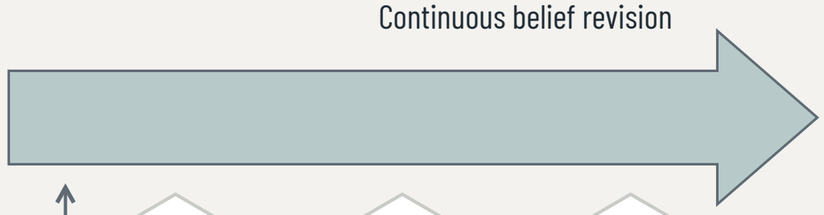
A more flexible way to read the next event.

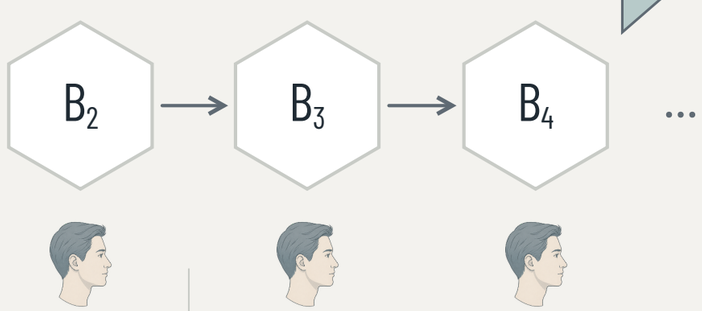






Continuous belief revision













Consequence

The relationship is strained.

Consequence

The relationship is repaired.

Next event

The first consequence becomes the next thing that happens.

Schematic: the stages and outcomes are illustrative, not measured.

After the ABC model of cognitive-behavioural therapy (A activating event, B belief, C consequence), with D and E shown as examination and revised outlook.